Aerial Lift Program

Policy

Aerial personnel lifts shall be operated, maintained, and controlled in a safe manner.

Purpose

To define the procedures and standards that apply to the care, control, maintenance, inspection, and operation of aerial personnel lifts.

Scope

Applies to all **Richco International Inc.** work sites, i.e., Richco International Inc. offices, client job sites, etc., requiring the use of aerial personnel lifts.

Definitions

Aerial personnel lift means any vehicle-mounted device, telescoping or articulating, or both, which is used to position personnel. These include extensible boom platforms, aerial ladders, articulating boom platforms, vertical towers, and a combination of any of the above.

Articulating boom platform means an aerial personnel lift with two or more hinged boom sections.

Extension boom platform means an aerial personnel lift (except ladders) with a telescopic or extension boom. Telescopic derricks with personnel platform attachments shall be considered to be extension boom platforms when used with a personnel platform.

Insulated aerial device means an aerial personnel lift designed for work on energized lines and apparatus.

Platform means any personnel-carrying device (basket or bucket) that is a component of an aerial personnel lift.

Vertical tower means an aerial personnel lift designed to elevate a platform in a substantially vertical axis.

Requirements

General

Equipment that is not designed for use as a personnel lift shall not be used as a personnel lift (e.g., front end loader buckets, backhoe buckets and cranes).

Only trained personnel who have been deemed competent and designated by their supervisor are authorized to operate aerial personnel lifts.

Lift controls shall be tested prior to use to determine that such controls are in safe working condition.

Review and follow fall protection requirements for aerial personnel lifts identified in Personnel should not be permitted to stand on the rails of aerial devices. A body harness shall be worn and a lanyard appropriately attached.

Personnel should not be permitted to stand on the rails of aerial devices. A body harness shall be worn, and a lanyard appropriately attached.

Personnel shall not be permitted to use an aerial personnel lift as a means of access. In the event that there are no other means of access, specific procedures including rationale (feasibly), duration, evacuation, fall protection, etc. shall be developed and reviewed with affected employees prior to implementation.

Large or excessive amounts of material, excluding tools, shall not be transported in an aerial personnel lift. Other material lifts would be necessary for such activities.

Load limits specified by the manufacturer shall not be exceeded.

Aerial personnel lifts that can operate horizontally shall set brakes and outriggers, when used, be positioned on pads or a solid surface, and chock wheels before using on an incline.

Boom and Ladder Lift Units

Before ladder trucks and tower trucks are moved from site to site, the aerial ladders shall be secured in the lower traveling position by the locking device above the truck cab, and the manually operated device at the base of the ladder, or by other equally effective means (e.g., cradles which prevent rotation of the ladder in combination with positive acting linear actuators).

An aerial lift truck may not be moved when the boom is elevated in a working position with personnel in the basket, except for equipment that is specifically designed for this type of operation.

Articulating boom and extendible boom platforms, primarily designed as personnel carriers, shall have both platform (upper) and lower controls. Upper controls shall be in or beside the platform within easy reach of the operator. Lower controls shall provide for overriding the upper controls. Controls shall be plainly marked as to their function. Lower-level controls shall not be operated unless permission has been obtained from the employee in the lift, except in case of emergency.

The insulated aerial devices shall not be altered in any manner that might reduce its insulating value. The insulated boom of a lift shall be regularly maintained and certified to ensure the continued insulating properties.

Before moving an aerial lift for travel, the boom(s) shall be inspected to see that it is properly cradled and outriggers are in stowed position.

Modifications

Aerial lifts may be "field modified" for uses other than those intended by the manufacturer, provided the modification has been certified in writing.

References

OSHA CFR 29 1926.453, .952(b), and .955(e)(12)
OSHA CFR 29 1910.67(b)(2)